

The background is a colorful, hand-drawn illustration of a Parisian street scene. On the left, a large, ornate church with multiple domes and spires sits atop a hill. The foreground shows a cobblestone street with several black lampposts and yellow-leaved trees. On the right, there are multi-story buildings with red-tiled roofs and balconies. In the far distance, the Eiffel Tower rises above the city skyline. A white rectangular box with a torn top edge is centered over the illustration, containing the title and subtitle.

Discovering Amélie

A visual journey through cinema,
secrets, and the streets of Montmartre.

Meet Amélie Poulain



Childhood: Homeschooled due to a misdiagnosed heart defect; grew up isolated and highly imaginative.

Profession: Waitress at the Café des 2 Moulins in Montmartre.

Personality: Solitary, observant, and deeply appreciative of life's smallest pleasures.

The Chain Reaction of Kindness

August 31, 1997

Startled by the news of Princess Diana's death, Amélie drops a perfume stopper, revealing a hidden childhood box in her wall.



The Return

She tracks down the owner, Dominique Bretodeau, and returns the box anonymously, changing his life.

The Mission

Inspired, she becomes a secret guardian angel, helping a blind man, her father, and her coworkers.



The Romance

Her missions lead her to cross paths with Nino Quincampoix, a collector of discarded photo booth pictures, forcing her to finally pursue her own happiness.



Finding the Meaning



Exploring isolation, connection, and
the magic of everyday life.

The Weight of Isolation vs. Connection

Isolation



- A sheltered childhood



- The Glass Man painting alone



- Observing life from a distance



Connection

- Secretly matchmaking coworkers



- Returning the photo album to Nino



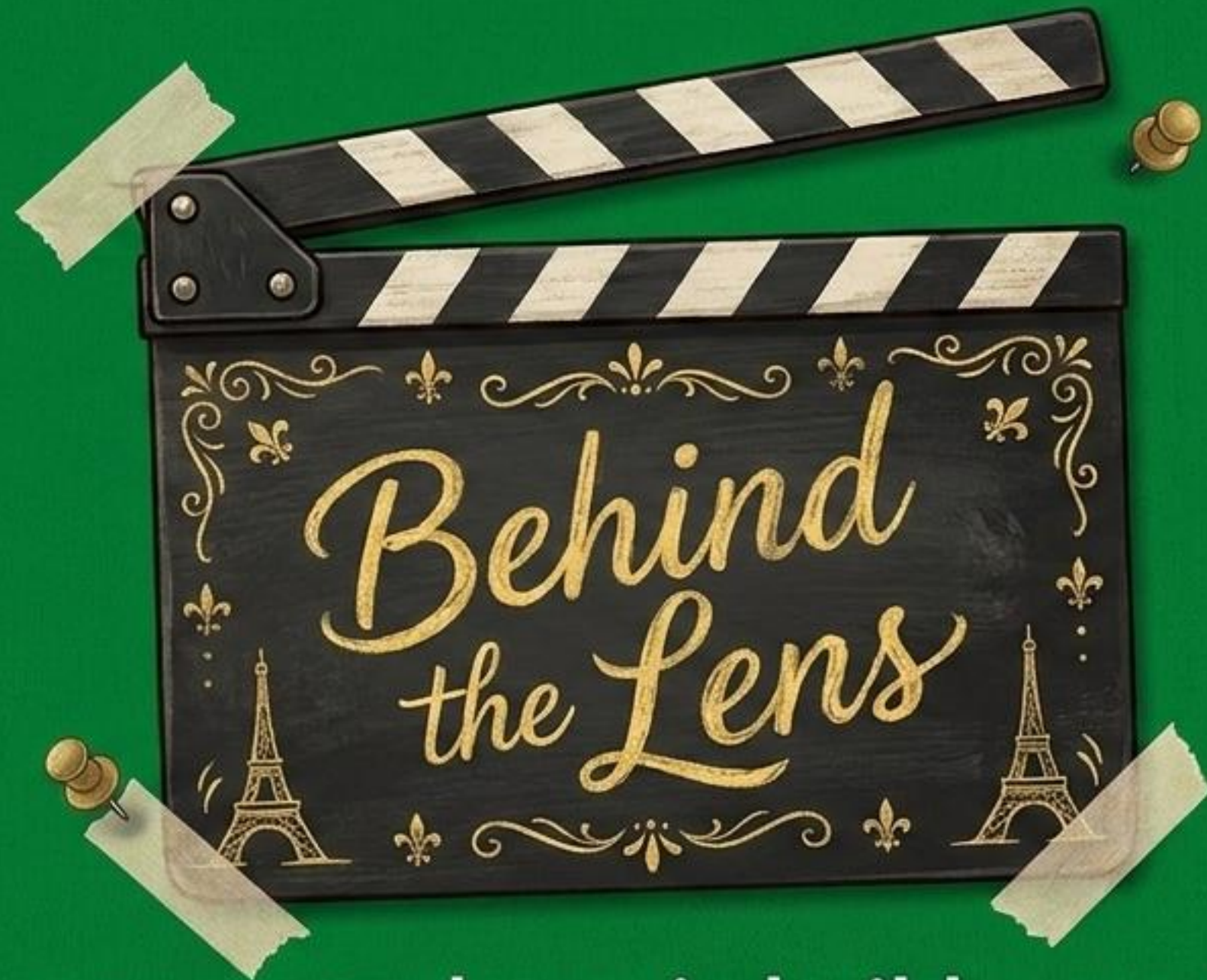
- Stepping into the real world



The Art of Small Pleasures



Behind the Lens



How color, camera, and music build a modern fairy tale.

Painting with Emotion



Red: Symbolizes passion, warmth, and love. Dominates Amélie's apartment and clothing.



Green: Represents hope and vitality. Balances the heavy reds.



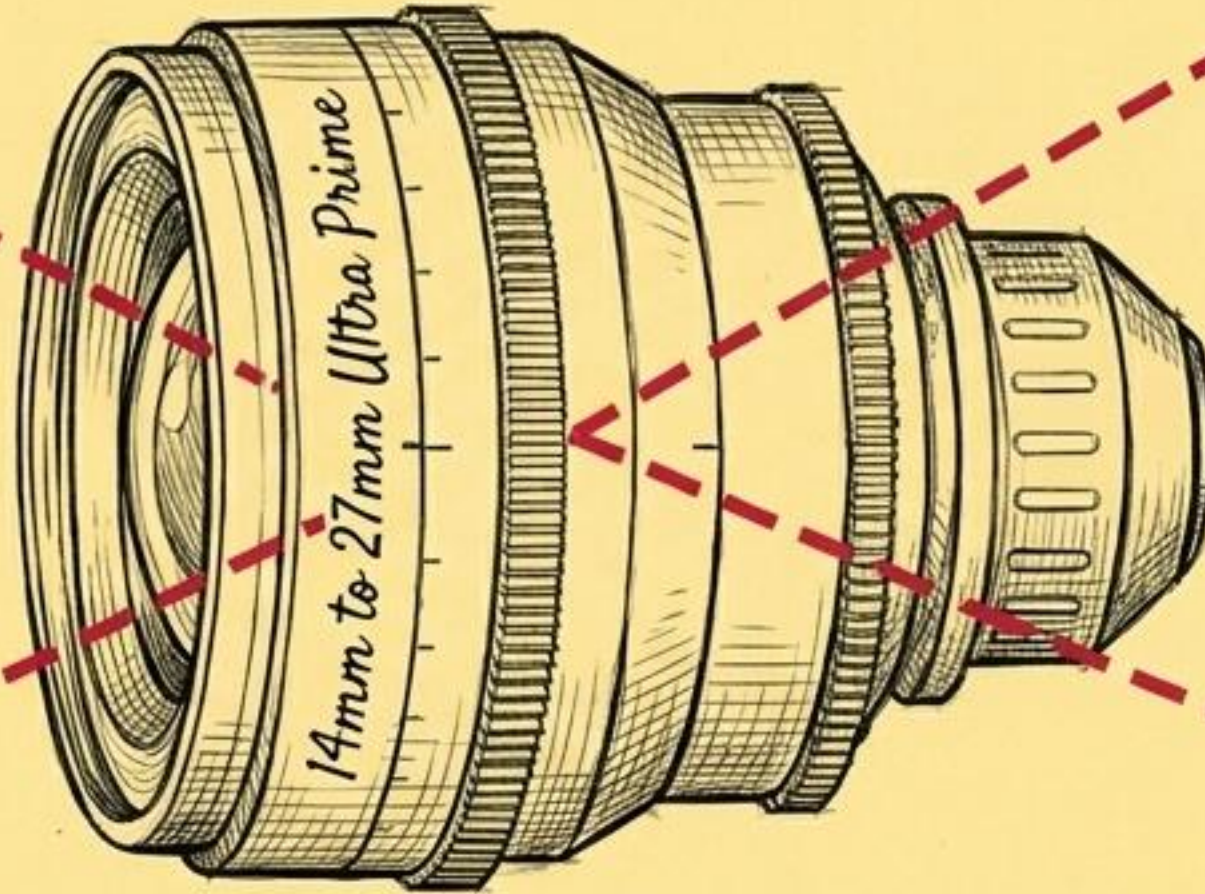
Yellow: Evokes nostalgia and joy, bathing the interiors in a warm, golden glow.



Blue: Used very rarely. Highlights moments of deep loneliness or vulnerability.

The Storybook Camera

Wide Angles: Shot almost entirely on 14mm to 27mm lenses to create a slightly distorted, dreamlike reality.



Deep Focus: Everything in the background stays perfectly clear, making the beautiful sets pop.

Dynamic Movement: The camera rarely stays still, sweeping and pushing in close to faces to capture unusual features and lively energy.

The Sound of Nostalgia



The Accordion:

Anchors the film in traditional French Bal-Musette culture and Parisian streets.



The Piano:

Creates fast, upbeat melodies for moments of joy, and slow, somber sequences for melancholy.



The Bicycle Wheel:

Yann Tiersen uniquely uses experimental sounds—like a spinning wheel—to capture childlike curiosity and innocence.

Fiction Versus Reality



Exploring the real streets
and the cinematic illusion.

Footsteps in Montmartre

Pin 1: Café des 2 Moulins (15 rue Lepic)

Where Amélie works.

Pin 2: Collignon Grocery (56 rue des Trois Frères)

The grumpy grocer's shop.

Pin 3: Lamarck-Caulaincourt

The iconic Art Nouveau Métro station.

Pin 4: Sacré-Cœur

The basilica offering panoramic views of the city.



A Tale of Two Cities

Jeunet's Cinematic Paris

- Streets digitally cleared of cars and dog dirt
- Posters changed to look vintage
- An idealized, all-white retro postcard version of the city

The Real Paris

- A bustling, unpredictable neighborhood
- High tourist foot traffic mixed with locals
- A culturally diverse reality that critics argue the film erased

Director Jean-Pierre Jeunet modified reality to create a fantasy painting, while critics argued it resulted in a sanitized, reactionary view of France.



Review Your Journey

A quick check of what
we've discovered.

Memory & Reflection

True or False?

1. Amélie finds the hidden box on the day Princess Diana dies. (T/F)
2. The color blue is used constantly in the film to show joy. (T/F)
3. The film was entirely shot as a realistic documentary of Montmartre. (T/F)

Which of Amélie's small pleasures (like skipping stones or cracking crème brûlée) do you relate to the most, and why?